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STOP TEXTING YOUR COMMISSION RATE.

The fastest reply to "what's your commission" is the one that costs you the listing appointment.

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THE FAST ANSWER IS THE **WRONG** ANSWER.

A seller who texts "what's your commission" is testing you, not asking for a number. Text back a percentage and you just answered the wrong question.

A TEXTED NUMBER TURNS THE WHOLE CONVERSATION INTO A PRICE COMPARISON.

The second you type a percentage back, the seller stops thinking about what you do and starts comparing you to whoever else answered their text. "In almost every area of life, price and quality travel together," HousingWire columnist Darryl Davis writes, and a bare number on a screen never makes that case. A phone call can explain what the fee actually pays for before the seller lines it up against someone else's text. A text can't.

NEXT TIME A SELLER TEXTS "WHAT'S YOUR COMMISSION":

- 1 Answer with a call, not a number.**
"Happy to walk you through that, when's a good time for a quick call?" moves the conversation somewhere value can actually get explained.
- 2 Frame the value before the price.**
Say what the marketing, negotiation, and process cost to do well, before the number comes up at all.
- 3 Give a range tied to the property, not a flat rate.**
The marketing plan and the property itself change the real number. Say that out loud instead of quoting one rate to everyone who texts.
- 4 Teach them how to interview agents.**
A seller who leaves the call knowing what to ask the next three agents almost always calls you back first.

THE TAKEAWAY

ANSWER WITH A CALL, NOT A NUMBER.

The agent who explains the fee gets the appointment. The agent who texts it gets compared.